

Full-Fledged Pentecostals

Text: Acts 2:1-4

When the Day of Pentecost had fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting. Then there appeared to them divided tongues, as of fire, and *one* sat upon each of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.

Intro:

I thank God for the opportunity to have been raised in a truly Pentecostal atmosphere. Someone asked the question, "What would you be if you were not Pentecostal?" The answer? "I would be ashamed."

The term "full-fledged" means, "having acquired all the feathers necessary for flight."

I must tell you that while I am honored to be an ordained Assembly of God minister, I am also very concerned about the fact that in many places, we have all but lost our Pentecostal distinctive.

(My own experience in Malvern, people who have been in Pentecost all of their lives, but evidently Pentecost never got in them.)

Very briefly I want us to look at four things that I believe is required in order that we will be "full-fledged" Pentecostals.

1. FULL-FLEDGED PEOPLE ARE PEOPLE OF PRAYER!

Prayer is probably one of the most discussed and least practiced theological topics of the church. Pentecostals have historically been known for their praying. "Bent knees make straight men." "He stands longest, who kneels lowest."

Jesus our great example laid out a pattern for us to follow:

- 1) Sometimes he rose a great while before dawn and went to prayer.
- 2) Sometimes he prayed all night.

- 3) He always prayed before making major decisions.
- 4) He prayed before performing the miracle of the loaves and the fishes.
- 5) He agonized in prayer in the garden of Gethsemane.

Prayer is difficult work. It involved warfare against principalities and powers of darkness. The only time the word "agony" appears in the Bible it is used in connection with the prayer of Jesus in the garden of Gethsemane!

I thank God for Pentecostal praying:

For the praise that it provides
For the poise that it promotes
For the prophecy that it prompts
For the patience that it prescribes
For the problems it prohibits
For the anger that it appeases
For the baptism that it brings
For the carnality that it crucifies
For the darkness that it dispels
For the evil that it eliminates
For the fire that it furnishes
For the grace that it grants
For the humility that it hastens
For the inspiration that it invites
For the joy that it generates
For the loves that it launches
For the mercy that it motivates
For the natures that it neutralizes
For the oneness that it originates
For the quarrels that it quiets
For the sin-problem that it satisfies
For the trinity that it trusts
For the unknown that it unveils
For the victory that it invigorates
For the wedding that it waits
For the example that it exemplifies
For the zeal that it zeroes in for us

2. FULL-FLEDGED PENTECOSTAL PEOPLE ARE PEOPLE OF POWER!

I am afraid that we are embarking upon a powerless Pentecost in this modern day church. The New Testament church had always been and

should always be a church of power.

Mark 16:17-18

And these signs will follow those who believe: In My name they will cast out demons; they will speak with new tongues; they will take up serpents; and if they drink anything deadly, it will by no means hurt them; they will lay hands on the sick, and they will recover."

Where are the miracles?

Pentecostal power is unlike the power of the world. It far exceeds other powers. Other powers have limitations, but Pentecostal power is unlimited. The reason it is unlimited is because it is God-breathed. This power is an example of man being clothes and impelled by Omnipotence! The book of Acts is commonly referred to as "The Acts of the Apostles," when in reality it is really "The Acts of the Holy Ghost" as revealed through a man.

In this book we are told of the conversion experience of Saul who became Paul. It was the power of God and not of man that brought such a miraculous change to this man's life. He was: Convicted, Convinced, Converted, Commissioned, and Catapulted in the ministry by the power of Pentecost. There is no "amen" at the close of the book because it is still being written.

I love this Pentecostal power:
For the purity that it makes possible
For the power that it produces
For the baptism that it brings
For the cross that it carries
For the demons that it defeats
For the empires that it erases
For the future that it furnishes
For the God that is glorifies
For the healing that it holds
For the King that it crowns
For the Lord that it lauds
For the messiah that it magnifies
For the oblation that it offers
For the souls that it saves
For the wretches that it reaches

God has provided a way for us to have Pentecostal power today!

Acts 1:8

But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.

3. FULL-FLEDGED PENTECOSTALS ARE PEOPLE OF PERSEVERANCE!

The early church was full of folks who had made up their mind to serve Jesus. I have trouble with whiny Pentecostal people. I thank God that I am a full-fledged Pentecostal. Despite the imperfections of some of its adherents, regardless of the frailties of some of its warriors, or the callousness of some of its champions, or the mistakes of some of its ministers, or the decay of some of its deacons or the treachery of some of its trustees, or the trickery of some of its teachers, or the backslidings of some of its backers.

I make a commitment today to be a Full-Fledged Pentecostal no matter what anyone else does.

4. FULL-FLEDGED PENTECOSTALS ARE PEOPLE WHO WILL PERPETUATE ANOTHER GENERATION OF PENTECOSTALS!

The early church was a generation of Pentecostals that knew how to perpetuate another generation of Pentecostals.

1. First there were 300
2. Then there were 3,000
3. Then those who were added daily
4. Then there were 5,000
5. Then there were multitudes, whole cities turned upside down through evangelism

I'm concerned that we are not perpetuation another generation that is truly Pentecostal. You cannot become Pentecostal through osmosis anymore than waitress will absorb food through her skin. There must be a rebirth of Pentecost in every generation! Just because you've attended a Pentecostal church does not mean you are a full-fledged Pentecostal. A fish can stay in salt water his entire life without the salt water getting in him!

There are those who go through the spiritual motions of being Pentecostal but they are not really Pentecostal!

It's time for those of us who are Pentecostal to stand up and show our true colors and have a Pentecostal revival.